2.1 Analyzing data mesh drivers

To decide whether a data mesh is the right choice for you, we need to analyze the decision drivers behind architecture selection. We split these drivers into three categories:

- Business drivers
- Organizational drivers
- Domain data drivers

Let's start with the most crucial aspect: business reasons.

2.1.1 Business drivers

We think you should start your analysis from the business side. If you can't find a suitable business reason to start your data mesh journey, stop there. You'll already have an answer: you don't need a data mesh.

BUSINESS STRATEGY

Look at your business strategy at the company level or, in the case of big corporations, at the unit level. Search for the answers to questions like these:

- Are we defining our company as data driven or planning to shift our strategy to be more data driven?
- Do we have objectives and key results (OKRs), or any goal-setting methodology, that requires data to be met?

NOTE *OKRs* is a methodology used to define goals for the company (and on the individual level). This methodology is often used as a tool to implement business strategies.

If the answer to these questions is *yes*, you can dig deeper and look for the specific business cases requiring data (which we cover in the next step). If the answer is *no*, your work is going to be more challenging. Business cases for data needs are often hidden in business unit strategies or in specific